



YOU ARE **26 WEEKS AND 6 DAYS**

**92 days to go**

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### YOUR BABY TODAY

Thumb-sucking is becoming much more coordinated as the sensitive lips and fingers meet. On scans most babies look as if they enjoy it, and there's no doubt that it provides important sensory feedback and perhaps reassurance to your developing baby.

**“The thought of being off work in the last months of pregnancy is tempting, but it will give you less time off with your baby.”**

As long as you're feeling in good health, try to work into the last month of your pregnancy. It can be particularly frustrating if you finish two months before, only to find that your baby is born later than expected. Working as late as possible may also allow you to spend some time with your replacement. If you're finding work tiring, try to adapt your working day and avoid traveling during rush hour, if possible. Whenever you start your leave, colleagues may hold a party and want to buy gifts for your newborn. If you're asked what you want, suggest gift certificates since these will allow you to purchase some of the more expensive baby equipment, and prevent duplication of gifts. Many stores also offer baby registries, which are a good way to choose the items you want.

### BACK PAIN IN THE THIRD TRIMESTER

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**One of the most common pregnancy complaints**, back pain is generally a reaction to your increased weight and the laxity of the joints that are an integral part of pregnancy. You can alleviate this, and evidence suggests that women who exercise are far less likely to suffer from extreme back pain than those who don't.

Do exercises to strengthen your abdominal muscles, which will give your belly and your back support, and keep your legs and arms strong too. See an effective [abdominal workout](#).

Carrying does not end when you have your baby. You will have a car seat, diaper bag, and perhaps groceries or older children to carry, as well as your newborn. So it's best to keep your muscles strong to prepare for this. Here are five tips to avoid back pain in the third trimester:

- **Stay strong:** strength training for all parts of your body (see [A safe workout](#)) will help you deal with the weight you are gaining throughout pregnancy.
- **Support:** invest in a support belt that will give your back a break from bearing the load of your belly. It will also support your sagging belly and may relieve the pressure in your legs. This can be particularly useful if you're carrying twins or more.